

THE ZERO-TO-SMM ROADMAP

For the girl who has **zero basics**, no course, no Canva skills, no editing skills but is finally ready to stop saying “I’ll start tomorrow.”

NOW OR NEVER. LEARN IT. PRACTICE IT. IMPLEMENT IT. EARN FROM IT.

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You do NOT need to be talented before you begin.
You need to begin so you can become good.

BEFORE WE START

This roadmap starts at *absolute zero*.

If you are waiting for motivation, this roadmap is not for you. If you are ready to take action, welcome.

THIS IS FOR YOU IF:

- You have zero or very little knowledge of social media management.
- You have not taken an SMM course yet and want to start from scratch.
- You do not know how to use Canva.
- You have little or no video-editing experience.
- You want to learn using FREE resources only.
- You can give at least 3 hours a day: 2 hours learning + 1 hour implementing.
- You are willing to practice even when your first designs look bad.
- You want to build proof, get experience and eventually earn from SMM.

THIS IS NOT FOR YOU IF:

- You keep saving tutorials but never open them.
- You keep saying “I’ll start tomorrow.”
- You want clients before you can actually deliver the work.
- You want a shortcut instead of a skill.
- You expect a roadmap to do the work for you.

The rule: You do not need to finish everything today. But you do need to do *today’s work today*.

YOUR NON-NEGOTIABLE ROUTINE

3 hours a day. That’s the deal.

You are not being asked to study all day. You are being asked to show up consistently.

2 HOURS	LEARN Watch/read the exact lesson for the day. Take short notes. Do not open 15 different tutorials.
1 HOUR	IMPLEMENT Create something with what you just learned. Your practice work can be ugly. It just cannot be imaginary.

THE 5 RULES

- Learn one thing → practice one thing. Do not just consume content.
- Use free resources. Do not buy a course because you feel behind.
- Do not jump to client hunting before you have basic skills and proof.
- Keep every practice piece. Your first bad design is still evidence that you started.
- If you miss a day, restart the next day. Do not turn one missed day into one missed month.

No recorded lessons from Areesha Malik are being provided. The roadmap tells you exactly what to learn and where to will be informed in group

STEP 1 — BUILD YOUR FOUNDATION

First understand what an SMM actually does.

Before Canva, reels or clients, you need to understand the job. Social media management is not simply “posting pictures.” You help a business use social platforms to reach the right people, communicate clearly, build trust and support business goals.

LEARN THESE BASICS

- What is Social Media Management?
- What does a Social Media Manager do every day?
- Difference between content creator, social media manager, social media marketer and strategist.
- What are Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and LinkedIn used for?
- What is a target audience?
- What is a content pillar?
- What is a content calendar?
- What is engagement?
- What are reach, impressions, saves, shares, watch time and profile visits?
- What is a social media strategy?

YOUR FIRST IMPLEMENTATION

- Pick one imaginary business: café, boutique, salon or fitness coach.
- Write their target customer.
- Write what that customer wants and what problem the business solves.
- Write why someone would follow the page.
- Choose 3–5 possible content pillars.

Move forward when you can explain the ideas in your own words. not just because you watched a video.

STEP 2 — LEARN CANVA FROM ZERO

You do not need to be a designer. You need to learn the tools.

Your first goal is not to make perfect graphics. Your first goal is to become comfortable opening Canva, choosing a size, adding text, using images, arranging elements and exporting.

(I WILL TEACH YOU OR GIVE YOU A RESOURCE TO LEARN THE EASY WAY)

STEP 3 — CONTENT + BASIC VIDEO EDITING

Now learn how to turn ideas into content.

A client will not only need pretty graphics. You should be able to think of content ideas, write simple hooks/captions and create basic short-form videos.

CONTENT SKILLS

- Generate content ideas from audience problems.

- Write a simple hook.
- Structure an educational post.
- Create promotional content without making every post a sales pitch.
- Write a basic caption with a clear call-to-action.
- Create 3–5 content pillars for a business.
- Turn one idea into a Reel, carousel, Story and static post.

YOUR 1-HOUR IMPLEMENTATION

Create one 15–30 second Reel for your imaginary business. It can be faceless. Use simple clips, text and a clear hook.

Do not spend 40 minutes hunting for the perfect template.

STEP 4 — BUILD PROOF YOU CAN SHOW

You cannot say “trust me.” Show them.

The original roadmap puts proof before outreach: mock case studies, sample posts and a content calendar give you something to send before pitching.

(I will tell you about this as well)

YOUR BEGINNER PORTFOLIO

- Choose 1 starting niche: café, boutique, salon, fitness coach, local service, etc.
- Create 2 mock client projects in that niche.
- For each: business problem → target audience → strategy → content pillars.
- Create 3–5 sample posts for each mock client.
- Create at least 1 Reel sample.
- Create a 7-day sample content calendar.
- Put everything into a simple Canva PDF or Instagram portfolio.

A SIMPLE CASE STUDY FORMAT

1. PROBLEM What is not working?	2. AUDIENCE Who are we speaking to?
3. STRATEGY What will we do and why?	4. CONTENT What will we create?
5. RESULT For mock work, label goals/expected results.	6. NEXT STEP What would we test next?

STEP 5 — PRACTICE BEFORE YOU SELL

Get real reps without putting a big client at risk.

The source roadmap recommends 1–2 low-stakes practice projects: mock work shows strategy, while real practice shows execution.

YOUR OPTIONS

- Manage your own Instagram like a client account: plan, create, post and track.
- Help a friend's/family member's small business for a limited trial period.
- Create a spec redesign for an existing local business — clearly label it as unsolicited/spec work.
- Ask permission before accessing or changing someone else's account.
- Set a clear start/end date so free work does not become endless work.

TRACK YOUR WORK

- What did I post?
- Why did I post it?
- What was the hook?
- What action did I want the audience to take?
- What happened after posting?
- What would I change next time?

YOUR GOAL IS NOT PERFECTION. YOUR GOAL IS REPS.

By the end of this stage, you should be able to show actual work and explain why you made it.

STEP 6 — START REACHING OUT

Now you have something to show. Use it.

The original roadmap recommends local businesses, your existing network and Instagram searches as starting points, with specific, low-pressure outreach.

FIND LEADS

- Search Instagram for local cafés, boutiques, salons, coaches and service businesses.
- Look for pages that post inconsistently or have weak content structure.
- Make a short list of businesses whose audience and content you understand.
- Study each page before messaging. Do not send the exact same message to everyone.

OUTREACH GOAL

Start small and stay consistent. The original roadmap suggests 5 businesses a week as a manageable starting point.

WHAT YOU CAN OFFER

- Content creation
- Content + scheduling
- Full social media management
- A small starter package based on what you can actually deliver.

NEVER SELL A SERVICE YOU CANNOT YET DELIVER.

STEP 7 — LAND, DELIVER & GROW

Getting the client is only half the job.

Before work starts, agree on scope, deliverables, price, content access, approvals, turnaround time and revisions. During the project, communicate clearly and use a content calendar.

AFTER YOUR FIRST PROJECT

- Ask for a short testimonial.
- Ask whether they know another business that needs help.
- Add real results to your portfolio.
- Write down what worked and what did not.
- Improve your process before taking on more clients.

AS YOU GROW

- Raise your rate gradually for new clients.
- Keep your onboarding and content-calendar systems organized.
- Keep learning analytics, strategy, paid ads and deeper content skills.
- Do not confuse more clients with more success. Better delivery matters.

LEARN → PRACTICE → BUILD PROOF → REACH OUT → DELIVER → REPEAT

Areesha Malik

The point is not to know everything. The point is to stop waiting and become someone who can actually do the work.